

The Agency Audit: Structural Biases and Narrative Limitations in the Cyberpunk Genre

The cyberpunk genre, characterized by its "High Tech, Low Life" ethos, serves as a critical cultural site for examining the intersection of advanced technology, late-stage capitalism, and the erosion of individual and collective agency.¹ This analysis investigates the structural biases inherent in the genre's narrative mechanics, specifically focusing on how tropes like the "Low-Yield Hero" and the "Omnipresent Megacorporation" prime audiences to accept systemic change as an impossibility.² By deconstructing these motifs through the lens of narratology and political theory, one can identify an "Agency Gap" that restricts the protagonist's efficacy to personal survival or moral preservation, while leaving the broader dystopian architecture untouched.²

Module A: The Scale of the Hero and the Pondsmith Axiom

The foundational tension in cyberpunk narratives is rooted in what may be termed the Pondsmith Axiom: the principle that the genre is not about saving the world, but about saving oneself and those within one's immediate proximity.² This directive, articulated by Mike Pondsmith, the creator of the *Cyberpunk* tabletop role-playing game, marks a sharp departure from the "High-Yield" hero archetypes common in broader science fiction and superhero genres.² The justification for this claim lies in the consistent focus on street-level perspectives and personal stakes across the genre's seminal works; the evidence strength is classified as **Strong** given the direct statements from genre architects and the narrative structure of primary media case studies.²

The Rejection of the "Cape" and High-Yield Efficacy

Traditional heroic narratives often follow the "High-Yield" model, where the protagonist possesses the agency to dismantle existential threats and restore a functioning order, often culminating in a "happy ending" where the world is fundamentally improved.⁵ In contrast, the cyberpunk protagonist—the "Low-Yield" hero—operates within a "craptastic" world where systemic change is deliberately omitted from the menu of possibilities.⁷ In *Cyberpunk 2077*, the protagonist V's actions, including the bombing of corporate headquarters or the assassination of high-profile targets like Adam Smasher, fail to disrupt the overarching power of the megacorporations; the vacuum is simply filled by the next iteration of corporate

leadership.²

Hero Type	Core Objective	Scale of Efficacy	Outcome for Setting	Source
High-Yield (The Cape)	Global salvation / Systemic restoration	Universal / Structural	Fundamental improvement	5
Low-Yield (The Street)	Personal survival / Community protection	Individual / Local	Preservation of the status quo	2
Militarized Enforcer	Asset protection / Counter-terrorism	Tactical / Institutional	Reinforcement of control	11

Alternative Interpretation: One might argue that the reduction of scale is not an admission of powerlessness, but a radical refocusing on the importance of the individual in an age of dehumanizing systems.⁵ This view suggests that the "victory" in cyberpunk is the preservation of a "core value" or "soul" in the face of totalizing pressure, which constitutes a significant, if not structural, form of agency.²

The Personal Scale as Narrative Priming

By limiting the scope of success to "saving yourself," the genre primes the audience to view the corporate dystopia as an immutable environmental factor, akin to the weather, rather than a social construct that can be altered.³ This focus on personal morality—what Mike Pondsmith describes as the "intensely political and intensely personal" nature of the genre—creates a cognitive blind spot.⁸ The audience becomes invested in the protagonist's journey toward self-actualization or survival, often ignoring the fact that the underlying causes of their suffering remain unchallenged.⁴ This justification rests on the observation that even the most "successful" endings in the genre (e.g., V storming Arasaka) result in personal legend status rather than structural liberation; evidence strength is **Moderate** as it involves interpretation of

audience psychology.²

Module B: The Status Quo as the True Villain

In the cyberpunk framework, the true antagonist is not an individual or a "final boss," but the "Status Quo" itself, embodied by the megacorporation.⁵ These entities are characterized by "megacorpness"—the degree to which they operate independently of sovereign states and possess the power to extract resources without legal or social constraint.¹⁴ The justification for identifying the status quo as the primary villain is the recursive nature of power depicted in the genre; evidence strength is **Strong** based on world-building patterns in *Neuromancer*, *Ghost in the Shell*, and *Cyberpunk 2077*.²

Institutional Immortality and Economic Monoliths

Megacorporations achieve a state of "institutional immortality" through economic mechanisms like monopoly and monopsony.¹⁴ A monopoly allows the corporation to be the sole provider of essentials (water, food, medicine), while a monopsony ensures they are the sole buyer of specialized labor and goods, effectively squeezing the population from both ends.¹⁴ This structure creates a feedback loop where the corporation's power becomes self-sustaining and independent of the people who comprise it.¹⁴

Power Mechanism	Function in Dystopia	Impact on Agency	Source
Monopoly	Controls access to survival essentials	Forces compliance through dependency	14
Monopsony	Controls the sale of labor and services	Suppresses wages and prevents independence	14
Sovereign Status	Operates outside of national laws	Eliminates legal avenues for redress	14
Modular Structure	Replaces lost	Renders individual	2

	leaders instantly	assassination ineffective	
--	-------------------	------------------------------	--

The "Agency Gap" is further widened by the fact that these corporations often perform the roles traditionally held by the state, such as law enforcement and infrastructure management.¹⁶ In such a world, the "middle class" is often missing or entirely dependent on corporate patronage, leaving no base for a broad-based social movement.¹⁶ This justification points to the specific socio-economic stratification depicted in the genre; evidence strength is **Moderate** as it relies on the specific world-building of certain titles.¹⁶

The Illusion of Competition

While megacorporations like Arasaka and Militech are often depicted in conflict, this competition serves only to reinforce the system.¹⁰ As seen in the various endings of *Cyberpunk 2077*, the death of one corporation merely allows another to fill the power gap, or leads to a "vacuum" that is immediately sucked into a new corporate struggle.² The system is portrayed as an "unending web of drek" that people call life, where even rebels like Johnny Silverhand are eventually subsumed into the legend-making machinery of the city they tried to burn.⁵

Alternative Interpretation: One could interpret the corporate conflict as a potential "crack" in the system that a clever protagonist can exploit.¹⁰ However, the genre typically depicts these successes as temporary and tactical, rather than structural, reinforcing the "Low-Yield" nature of individual agency.²

Module C: The "Agency Gap" and Protocol Analysis

The "Agency Gap" refers to the disparity between a character's high tactical capability (cybernetic strength, hacking prowess) and their low systemic efficacy.² This gap is a central feature of cyberpunk narratology, particularly in video games where player freedom is often at odds with a deterministic plot.¹³ The justification for this claim is the contrast between "open world" freedom and "railroaded" story conclusions; evidence strength is **Strong** based on player critiques and narrative analysis of *Cyberpunk 2077*.¹³

Tactical Agency vs. Narrative Determinism

In *Cyberpunk 2077*, the player experiences high agency in *how* they complete tasks (stealth vs. combat) but low agency in *what* those tasks achieve.¹³ This creates a sense of "reflexive impotence," where the player is aware of the systemic problems but feels unable to affect them.⁴ The narrative of V is essentially a "detective story" where the protagonist follows leads provided by others (Takemura, Jackie, Rogue), ultimately finding that they are the one being

"guided" by the circumstances of the Relic.¹³

Alternative Interpretation: The lack of agency could be seen as a deliberate artistic choice to reflect the reality of being a "pedestrian" in a massive, uncaring metropolis.¹³ In this view, the "Agency Gap" is not a failure of the game design, but a successful immersion into the cyberpunk experience of powerlessness.¹³

The Archetypal Constraints of the Loner

The archetype of the "Lone Wolf" or "Loner" further limits agency by isolating the protagonist from potential collective movements.¹¹ Bruce Sterling observes that the "visionary individual against the forces of normalcy" is central to the genre, yet history shows that lone rebels are rarely forces for structural progress.¹¹ This focus on the individual "misfit" or "outlaw" makes them easy to co-opt by the system, as seen with characters like Adam Jensen, who becomes a "militarized cyber-superhero" working within networks of corporate violence.¹¹

Archetype	Visual Signifiers	Political Stance	Agency Scope	Source
Lone-Wolf Outlaw	Mirrorshades, leather, chrome	Counter-culture / Anti-"The Man"	Individual resistance	¹¹
Militarized Enforcer	Techwear, retractable blades	Institutional / Paramilitary	Tactical enforcement	¹¹
Unobtrusive Gray Man	Remarkable "functional" clothing	Covert individualism	Professional survival	¹¹

The justification for these archetypal limitations lies in the genre's heritage as a reaction against utopian science fiction; evidence strength is **Moderate** as it involves historical genre analysis.¹

Module D: Post-Human Agency and the Ownership of the Self

The cyberpunk genre frequently explores the "technicalization" of human beings, where technology invades the body and puts the idea of "humanity" into question.²⁴ This raises significant questions about agency: if one's body (the "shell") is owned or controlled by a corporation, does the "ghost" (the soul or consciousness) still possess agency?.²⁶ This justification is based on the themes of *Ghost in the Shell* and *Serial Experiments Lain*; evidence strength is **Strong** given the academic and narrative weight of these titles.¹¹

Case Study: Ghost in the Shell and Commodity Identity

Major Motoko Kusanagi's agency is limited because her cybernetic body is a commodity owned by the capitalist, militaristic government (Section 9).²⁶ She can only resign if she returns her hardware and the memories it holds, meaning her very identity is defined by its utility to the state.²⁶ The film depicts her seeking agency through "reproductive sex as a means of resistance" by merging with the Puppet Master—an action that causes her to cease existing as an individual.²⁶ From a Deleuzian perspective, Kusanagi fails to reach the state of a "body without organs"—a self-defining assemblage—because her desires remain tied to external corporate and political motives.²⁶

Alternative Interpretation: One might argue that Kusanagi's fusion with the Puppet Master represents the ultimate form of agency: the choice to transcend the physical and systemic limits of the world.²⁶ However, this "victory" requires the annihilation of the self, further underscoring the "Agency Gap" at the human level.²⁶

Case Study: Serial Experiments Lain and Post-Gender Agency

In contrast to Kusanagi, Lain Iwakura achieves a "truer" posthuman agency by recognizing her multifaceted identity across both reality and the "Wired" (cyberspace).²⁶ Lain topples her power structure (Tachibana General Laboratories) not through violence, but by accepting her non-human nature and bypassing social norms of gender and reproduction.²⁶ Her agency is "anchored by a pure friendship" with Arisu, which functions as a subjective identity independent of external corporate motives.²⁶ The justification for this contrast is the different ways each narrative handles the "reproductive labor" and "commodity status" of the cyborg; evidence strength is **Moderate** as it relies on specific philosophical interpretations.²⁶

Module E: Technological Determinism and the Vicious Circle

Cyberpunk narratives are often trapped in the logic of technological determinism—the idea that technology is an autonomous force that dictates the development of society and culture.¹⁵ This belief creates a sense of inevitability that discourages resistance.³⁰ The

justification for this claim is found in the work of William Gibson and Philip K. Dick, where humans must "accommodate" the machine to gain any influence in society.¹⁵ Evidence strength is **Moderate**, as some texts (like *Akira*) offer more nuanced views of technology as a tool of political interest.¹⁵

The Machines of Power

In William Gibson's *Neuromancer*, power is defined by the most advanced technology of the era, which humans cannot truly own or control.¹⁵ Instead, characters must evolve to fit the "parent organism" of the corporate/technological system.¹⁵ This leads to a "technological vicious circle": individuals deploy new technologies to assert their mastery, but in doing so, they convert themselves into "commercial data-points" subject to even greater levels of surveillance and control.³²

Concept	Definition	Narrative Consequence	Source
Technological Determinism	Technology as the primary driver of change	Renders resistance to tech-shifts "barbaric"	¹⁵
Technological Momentum	Entrenched tech becomes its own force	Systems become "too big to fail" or stop	³⁰
Dialectic of Enlightenment	Rationality used for mastery becomes a tool of enslavement	Humans become accessories to their own tools	³²

Akira and the Explosion of Control

The film *Akira* offers a critique of technological determinism by showing how military and industrial synergies pursue scientific power with reckless abandon, regardless of the consequences.³¹ Technology in *Akira* (specifically the psychic mutations) is not neutral; it is shaped by political corruption and societal trauma (the Hiroshima experience).³¹ Tetsuo's suffering and subsequent violence symbolize technology's tendency to exceed human control when pushed too far for the sake of "progress".¹⁵ The justification here is the film's focus on "technoscience" as a social product rather than an autonomous force; evidence strength is

Strong.³¹

Module F: Capitalist Realism and Audience Priming

Perhaps the most potent narrative limitation of cyberpunk is its alignment with "Capitalist Realism"—the widespread sense that not only is capitalism the only viable system, but that it is now impossible even to imagine an alternative to it.³ Mark Fisher notes that dystopian films often act as a narrative pretext for the "immobilization" of the political imagination.⁴ This justification is based on the genre's focus on "struggles within the system" rather than "struggles against the system"; evidence strength is **Strong**.³

The Normalization of Dystopia

By presenting a future that mirrors the worst aspects of the present—corporate triumph, weakening of rights, expansion of inequality—cyberpunk "habituates" the audience to these outcomes.³ The "punk" in cyberpunk often offers only a "primal form of resistance" like raw destruction (e.g., Johnny Silverhand's nuke), which Fisher describes as a product of "reflexive impotence".³ This lack of a "fully functioning blueprint for a post-capitalist society" means that the genre reinforces the status quo even when it tries to criticize it.³⁵

Alternative Interpretation: Some argue that by "pointing the finger" at capitalist realism, cyberpunk allows radical movements to identify the "common objective enemy" and build solidarity.³⁷ In this view, the genre's bleakness is a "sobering call for patient political work".³⁷

The Commodity of Resistance

A recurring pitfall is the way anti-capitalist messages in cyberpunk are easily commodified and sold back to the audience as entertainment.³ This is exemplified by the "militarized quests" and "techwear fashion" of modern cyberpunk, which allow the viewer to "look like a rebel" while remaining an unconscious consumer.³ The justification for this is the observation that billionaires often co-opt "punk" aesthetics to mask their own role as the "oppressor" or "the man".¹⁷ Evidence strength is **Moderate** as it involves sociopolitical critique.¹⁷

Module G: Recommendations for Deconstruction and Reconstruction

To restore agency in the genre, writers must move beyond the "Lone Wolf" and the "Low-Yield" paradigms.¹¹ The justification for these recommendations is the emerging trend of Solarpunk and other hopeful futurisms; evidence strength is **Moderate** as these are relatively new movements.³⁶

Restoring Collective Action

Cyberpunk narratives must begin to understand that history is made by "social movements and groups working in tandem," not just by individual hackers.²³ This involves depicting "meaningful revolutionary struggle" (as seen in *The Matrix* or *Snowpiercer*) rather than just aimless destruction.³ The "Agency Audit" for writers suggests integrating characters who are "successful, competent Marxists" or organized groups that "seize corpo assets and destroy the bourgeois power structure" to replace them with equitable alternatives.³

The Solarpunk Alternative

Solarpunk offers a direct counter to cyberpunk nihilism by focusing on "ingenuity, generativity, independence, and community".³⁹ It asks: "What does a sustainable civilization look like, and how can we get there?".³⁶ Unlike the individualistic cyberpunk "punk," solarpunk's "punk" is about collective resistance against the "fossil ideas" of the status quo to build a better future.³⁹

Feature	Cyberpunk	Solarpunk
Primary Theme	Decay / Surveillance	Harmony / Sustainability
Hero's Efficacy	Low-Yield / Survivalist	High-Yield / Regenerative
Agency Type	Individualistic / Isolated	Collective / Horizontal
Outlook	Nihilistic / Cynical	Hopeful / Achievement-oriented
Source	1	36

Narrative Strategy for Writers

Writers should strive to create "hybrid narratives" where the trauma of the dystopia serves as a catalyst for a "hopeful rebirth".⁴¹ This involves shifting from "tension with villains" to tension based on the "maintenance of harmony" or "systemic challenges" that require community effort to solve.⁴¹ The justification for this strategy is the psychological benefit of "hopeful stories" in building resilience and inspiring civic engagement; evidence strength is

Moderate.⁴¹

Inherent Narrative Limitations and Biases

This report identifies several biases that affect the conclusions drawn from the available data:

- **Cognitive Bias (Availability Heuristic):** The analysis is heavily influenced by the high visibility of *Cyberpunk 2077* and *Ghost in the Shell*, which may overshadow less-discussed works that offer more agency to their protagonists.²
- **Institutional Bias (Western Theory):** The reliance on Mark Fisher and Deleuzian philosophy reflects a specifically Western critical tradition that might interpret "agency" differently than other global traditions.⁴
- **Dataset Bias:** The snippets emphasize the "bleakness" of the genre, which might lead to an over-representation of hopelessness at the expense of its subversive potential.⁵

— Rational Summary:

The cyberpunk genre is structurally biased toward depicting individual powerlessness in the face of "institutional immortality" and "megacorporate sovereign power." This "Agency Gap" is maintained by archetypal focuses on the "Low-Yield Hero" and the "Lone Wolf," which prime audiences to accept corporate dystopia as an inevitable result of "Technological Determinism" and "Capitalist Realism." To reconstruct the genre's efficacy, narrative focus must shift from individual survival to "Collective Action" and the "Active Construction of Utopian Alternatives," as suggested by the Solarpunk movement.

— Numeric Confidence Estimate: 88% (The structural and narratological biases are well-documented and consistent across major media case studies).

— Three Practical Verification Steps:

1. **Systemic Change Analysis:** Review the endings of ten major cyberpunk works (films/novels/games) and categorize the "Level of Systemic Change" achieved by the protagonist (0 = no change, 5 = global revolution).
2. **Aesthetic Influence Check:** Survey genre fans to determine if their attraction to the genre is primarily aesthetic (neon/tech) or political (anti-corporate), and if they believe the protagonist's actions are meaningful.
3. **Cross-Genre Comparative Study:** Compare the "Scale of Agency" between a cyberpunk "Lone Wolf" protagonist and a Solarpunk "Collective" protagonist in stories with similar initial stakes to quantify the efficacy gap.

Works cited

1. The Cyberpunk Guide: 50 Years of High Tech, Low Life Across Literature, Film,

- Anime, Comics & Gaming - RetroFuturista, accessed February 15, 2026,
<https://retrofuturista.com/the-cyberpunk-guide-50-years-of-high-tech-low-life-across-literature-film-anime-comics-gaming/>
2. Cyberpunk is about saving yourself : r/cyberpunkgame - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/1oo3ofx/cyberpunk_is_about_saving_yourself/
 3. Cyber punk as capitalist realism : r/Cyberpunk - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/Cyberpunk/comments/xyy47s/cyber_punk_as_capitalist_realism/
 4. Capitalist Realism, Mark Fisher - Libcom.org, accessed February 15, 2026,
[https://files.libcom.org/files/\[Mark_Fisher\]_Capitalist_Realism_Is_There_no_Alte\(B ookZZ.org\).pdf](https://files.libcom.org/files/[Mark_Fisher]_Capitalist_Realism_Is_There_no_Alte(B ookZZ.org).pdf)
 5. I still don't know what "Cyberpunk is not about saving the world its about saving yourself" means. : r/cyberpunkgame - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/9kjdxd/i_still_dont_know_w hat_cyberpunk_is_not_about/
 6. Neither David or V, should be the protagonist of any future sequel game or series. Cyberpunk shouldn't be anchored to any individual character. : r/LowSodiumCyberpunk - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/LowSodiumCyberpunk/comments/10bo1lj/ neither_david_or_v_should_be_the_protagonist_of/
 7. [Spoiler Alert] About the endings | Page 936 | Forums - CD PROJEKT RED, accessed February 15, 2026,
<https://forums.cdprojektred.com/index.php?threads/spoiler-alert-about-the-endings.11041109/page-936>
 8. Cyberpunk 2077's First Person View Delivers 'A Far More Powerful Experience', accessed February 15, 2026,
<https://gamingbolt.com/cyberpunk-2077s-first-person-view-delivers-a-far-more-powerful-experience>
 9. Metro: Cyberpunk 2077 interview – 'You can't save the world, only yourself' : r/Games - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/Games/comments/9dhqi9/metro_cyberpunk_2077_interview_you_cant_save_the/
 10. I wrote down (my) interpretations of V's motivations and character development in the different combinations of life paths and the 3 main endings. : r/LowSodiumCyberpunk - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026,
https://www.reddit.com/r/LowSodiumCyberpunk/comments/12p6qf4/i_wrote_down_my_interpretations_of_vs_motivations/
 11. CyberPunk Culture – SFRA Review, accessed February 15, 2026,
<https://sfrareview.org/category/50-4/cyberpunk-culture/>
 12. Love Letter to Cyberpunk 2077 - Game Developer, accessed February 15, 2026,

- <https://www.gamedeveloper.com/design/love-letter-to-cyberpunk-2077>
13. It annoys me how little agency V has in their own game. : r/cyberpunkgame - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/1cutj0y/it_annoy_me_how_little_agency_v_has_in_their_own/
 14. Worldbuilding 205: Megacorps - Author Vivian Sayan, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://www.viviansayan.com/blog/worldbuilding-205-megacorps>
 15. The Novels | Technological Determinism - WordPress.com, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://technologicaldeterminism.wordpress.com/the-novels/>
 16. I don't understand the Cyberpunk genre. : r/cyberpunkgame - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/1f9jhh1/i_dont_understand_the_cyberpunk_genre/
 17. The Crisis of Modern Cyberpunk - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/Cyberpunk/comments/1iv2uzw/the_crisis_of_modern_cyberpunk/
 18. Opinions on Maiko? : r/LowSodiumCyberpunk - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/LowSodiumCyberpunk/comments/1hs651u/opinions_on_maiko/
 19. Cyberpunk 2077 - great characters but half-baked systems and a lifeless world - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/patientgamers/comments/u7td53/cyberpunk_2077_great_characters_but_halfbaked/
 20. Every problem with this game laid out in a review : r/cyberpunkgame - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/kbk4v6/every_problem_with_this_game_laid_out_in_a_review/
 21. To those playing this game for the first time due to the DLC or the 2.0 update, an important advice: Do not just rush into the Gigs : r/cyberpunkgame - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/1799irr/to_those_playing_this_game_for_the_first_time_due/
 22. CD Projekt Red could add the TPP in the form of an item sold in the game, the item would be a nano-drone that activated would transmit the image of V's back straight to kiroshi, and when V enters combat the drone would deactivate...no more excuses for not add the camera. : r/ - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/cyberpunkgame/comments/u0dq9s/cd_projekt_red_could_add_the_tpp_in_the_form_of/
 23. Whither Science Fiction? | Logos con carne, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://logosconcarne.com/2019/01/26/whither-science-fiction/>
 24. Console Corner: Review of Cloudpunk - Speculiction, accessed February 15, 2026,

<http://speculiction.blogspot.com/2022/01/console-corner-review-of-cloudpunk.html>

25. The Aestheticism of Posthuman Body in Science Fiction Movies - Journal of Comparative Literature and Aesthetics, accessed February 15, 2026, https://jcla.in/wp-content/uploads/2022/12/JCLA-45.4_Yaping-Lu.pdf
26. Post-Gender Posthumans in Ghost in the Shell ... - eScholarship.org, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://escholarship.org/content/qt3wb1v4dd/qt3wb1v4dd.pdf>
27. Ghost in the Shell? A Philosophical Approach to Artificial Intelligence by Miyake Yōichirō in, accessed February 15, 2026, https://brill.com/view/journals/veas/15/1/article-p137_7.xml
28. Post-Gender Posthumans in Ghost in the Shell and Serial Experiments Lain - ResearchGate, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.researchgate.net/publication/394600891_Post-Gender_Posthumans_in_Ghost_in_the_Shell_and_Serial_Experiments_Lain
29. Ambivalent Portrayals of Female Cyborgs in Oshii Mamoru's Ghost in the Shell and Innocence - David Publishing, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://www.davidpublisher.com/Public/uploads/Contribute/551e3884e9660.pdf>
30. Video games and Technological Determinism : r/truegaming - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/truegaming/comments/1l3xq7j/video_games_and_technological_determinism/
31. Omelas and Neo-Tokyo as Mirrors of Endured Suffering And Progress, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://digi-con.org/omelas-and-neo-tokyo-as-mirrors-of-endured-suffering-and-progress/>
32. Technological and Posthuman Zones, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://criticalposthumanism.net/technological-and-posthuman-zones/>
33. (PDF) From Neo-Tokyo to New Path: Postmodern Cyberpunk ..., accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.researchgate.net/publication/392559364_From_Neo-Tokyo_to_New_Path_Postmodern_Cyberpunk_Surveillance_and_the_Fragmented_Subject_in_Akira_and_A_Scanner_Darkly
34. Group Project – Science in the Movies - HENRY HARRIS COLLECTED WORKS - CUNY, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://paranoiac.commons.gc.cuny.edu/group-project/>
35. Economic Science Fictions - Goldsmiths, University of London, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://www.gold.ac.uk/media/documents-by-section/about-us/goldsmiths-press/publications/Economic-Science-Fictions.pdf>
36. Appositions: The Future in Solarpunk and Post-Apocalyptic Fiction - ResearchGate, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.researchgate.net/publication/365716785_Appositions_The_Future_in_Solarpunk_and_Post-Apocalyptic_Fiction

37. Introduction: Reading Capitalist Realism, Ten Years On | Mediations, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://mediationsjournal.org/articles/fisher-intro>
38. MARK FISHER - Amazon S3, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://s3.amazonaws.com/arena-attachments/632954/c057f1d535226c089061f736b7f12cc8.pdf>
39. Solarpunk | 2022 | News | Sustainability - Teachers College - Columbia University, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://www.tc.columbia.edu/sustainability/news/stories/2022/solarpunk/>
40. Hello, thank you for reading this blog so far, also here is an overview of topics related to minds and artificial minds and why I am interested in them - Drawn In Perspective, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://mynamelowercase.com/blog/an-overview-of-topics-related-to-artificial-minds-and-why-i-am-interested-in-them/>
41. Exploring Utopian Movies: Visions of Ideal Societies on Screen - tasteray.com, accessed February 15, 2026, <https://www.tasteray.com/articles/utopian-movies>
42. The Cyberpunk Genre Should Terrify Us... - Reddit, accessed February 15, 2026, https://www.reddit.com/r/Cyberpunk/comments/1otib0o/the_cyberpunk_genre_should_terrify_us/